

Harshana Lakshara Fernando

📍 Panadura, Sri Lanka • 📞 +94 783 310 520 • ✉️ harshanalf.work@gmail.com
, 🌐 Portfolio • 🔗 LinkedIn • 🐙 GitHub • 📝 Medium

Summary

aBackend-focused Computer Science Engineering undergraduate with a rigorous foundation in **System Design**, **Distributed Systems**, and **Cloud-Native Engineering**. Proven experience architecting high-performance, fault-tolerant applications using **Microservices**, **Serverless Architectures**, and **Event-Driven Design** with **Java (Spring Boot)**, **Go**, **AWS Lambda**, and **Kafka**. Validated through the delivery of high-throughput systems handling massive load, seeking to solve complex **concurrency** and **low-latency** challenges within high-velocity engineering teams.

Education

B.Sc. (Hons) in Engineering – Computer Science and Engineering

2022 – 2026

University of Moratuwa, Sri Lanka

G.C.E. Advanced Level (Physical Science Stream)

2019

St. John's College, Panadura, Sri Lanka

Results: 3 A's (Combined Mathematics, Physics, Chemistry)

District Rank: 17

Experience

Software Engineer Intern

Dec 2024 – May 2025

Information Systems Associates (Pvt) Ltd — Aviation Technology Company

- **AeroOrder — Revamped Order Management Microservice (Java 17, Spring Boot, Grandle)**
 - Engineered a **distributed, high-throughput** unique ID generator for Passenger Name Records (PNRs) using a **Kafka**-backed pool model, ensuring uniqueness and security across scaled instances while adhering to aviation domain standards.
 - Optimized the PNR generation service to achieve **25+ PNRs/sec throughput** per node with **<100ms latency**, validating performance and resilience through extensive load, stress, and spike testing with **Apache JMeter**.
 - Resolved critical **production** issues, including **Kafka** consumer lag and offset resetting, by implementing robust shutdown hooks and enhanced retry mechanisms to improve fault tolerance and system recoverability.
 - Led **Research and Development** for **asynchronous load testing**, establishing a monitoring stack with **Prometheus** and **Grafana** to collect and visualize key performance metrics like queue time and latency.
 - Investigated and refactored inefficient **Kafka Streams** processing logic, building a proof-of-concept to validate a more efficient **Producer-Consumer** model that significantly reduced consumer lag and improved system stability.
 - Modernized the logging infrastructure by implementing structured **JSON logging**, which removed legacy dependencies and improved log parsing efficiency across all microservices.
- **AeroMart — Legacy Monolithic Passenger Reservation System (Java 8 ,Ant)**
 - Architected and implemented a hybrid integration strategy by embedding a **gRPC** client and **Kafka** consumer into a **legacy Java 8** monolith (AeroMart), enabling seamless, backward-compatible communication with the new **AeroOrder microservices** platform.
 - Developed dynamic, database-driven **feature toggles** to control PNR routing logic, minimizing risk during the phased **production rollout** by allowing for granular control and immediate fallback.
- **Other**
 - Authored comprehensive **design documents**, **sequence diagrams**, and **integration plans** on Confluence; facilitated knowledge transfer sessions to ensure seamless handover to the core development team.
 - Actively contributed to the **agile development lifecycle**, participating in all ceremonies, performing **code reviews**, and collaborating with cross-functional teams to deliver **production-ready** features using **Jira** and **Bitbucket**.

KEYWORDS: Java 18, Java 8, **Spring Boot**, **Spring Security**, Ant, **gRPC**, **Kafka**, React, Protobuf, REST API, Couchbase, Oracle DB, Oracle SQL, PostgreSQL, **JMeter**, Gatling, Ant Design, **Docker**, Docker Compose, Gradle, **Prometheus**, **Grafana**, Kibana, Confluence, Jira, Bitbucket, Microservices, **Kafka Streams**, JSON

Employee Management System (EMS) (2025 | Individual)

Architecture | Github 

Designed and built a comprehensive, cloud-native microservices application for employee and department management, featuring a full-stack architecture with a React/TypeScript frontend and Spring Boot backend.

- Architected a distributed system with independent microservices for employees, departments, and configuration, using **Spring Cloud** for service discovery (**Eureka**), centralized configuration, and an API gateway.
- Implemented robust fault tolerance using **Resilience4j**, incorporating **Circuit Breaker**, **Retry**, and **Rate Limiter** patterns to ensure system stability during partial failures.
- Enabled dynamic configuration management using **Spring Cloud Config Server** and **Spring Cloud Bus** with **RabbitMQ** for real-time property updates across services.
- Established a robust observability stack, integrating **Zipkin/Sleuth** for distributed tracing, the **ELK Stack** for centralized logging, and **Prometheus/Grafana** for real-time metrics and monitoring.
- Containerized all services using **Docker** and orchestrated local deployments with **Docker Compose**, while targeting **Kubernetes (OKE)** for production.
- Designed and managed a CI/CD pipeline using **GitHub Actions**, with **ArgoCD** for GitOps-based deployments to the Kubernetes cluster.

Keywords: Java 17, Spring Boot, Spring Cloud, React, TypeScript, Vite, Nginx, RabbitMQ, Resilience4j, MySQL, Docker, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions, ArgoCD, Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Nexus, GHCR

GoTogether – Intelligent Travel Companion for Sri Lanka (2024 | Group) Architecture | Live | Github

Developed and deployed a full-stack travel assistant platform tailored for Sri Lankan tourism, offering AI-based itinerary generation, real-time transport data, and social interaction features through a cloud-native microservices architecture.

- Led development of the web frontend using **Next.js** with secure authentication, session handling via cookies, SSR/CSR hybrid rendering, and route protection for authenticated access.
- Designed and implemented the **User Management module** within the **Social Media Service (Spring Boot)** to manage profiles, preferences, and social connections, integrating securely with **Keycloak** for identity management.
- Built a dedicated **Auth Service using Keycloak**, managing OAuth2/OIDC flows, token issuance, and automated realm/client boot-time import scripts.
- Solved startup dependency issues between services by writing a custom wait script to delay the social media service until Keycloak initialization completed, improving reliability.
- Configured **HTTPS for production with NGINX + Certbot + DuckDNS**, ensuring compatibility with Vercel's secure API policies.
- Developed the **API Service (Go)** to provide AI-based itinerary generation (via Gemini API) and map services using **gRPC** for high-performance inter-service communication.
- Optimized container builds using multi-stage Docker builds (Go service) and manual JAR injection (Spring Boot service) to reduce image size and speed up builds.
- Created a robust **deploy.sh script** to support local builds, selective service orchestration, and GitHub Actions-based CI/CD.
- Migrated backend infrastructure from **AWS EC2 to Oracle Cloud Free Tier**, improving stability, memory headroom, and deployment speed.

Keywords: Next.js, React Native, Go, Spring Boot, Kong, Keycloak, PostgreSQL, Cloudflare, Vercel, NGINX, Certbot, DuckDNS, Gemini API

Food Delivery Application (2024 | Group)

Github 

Built a scalable, event-driven food delivery platform inspired by systems like Uber Eats, using a modern microservices architecture. As part of the core team, I focused on designing and developing the Restaurant Service.

- Developed the Restaurant Module with secure sign-up/login using **Spring Security** and **JWT** (with extended claims).
- Built CRUD APIs for menu and item management; integrated **Redis caching** to improve performance and reduce database load, with appropriate cache invalidation strategies.
- Enabled order sync via **Kafka**: when an order is placed, an event is published to the 'order_created' topic, which the restaurant service consumes to update order details.
- Implemented real-time order state updates through Kafka's publish/subscribe model to keep restaurant and rider services in sync.

- Integrated **WebSockets** for real-time restaurant notifications (e.g., new orders, rider assignments).
- Built a secure "Forget Password" flow using time-sensitive tokens for authentication recovery.
- Implemented robust exception handling and API protection through middleware guards and JWT verification.
- Dockerized all components (frontend, backend, Kafka, Redis, PostgreSQL) and managed them via **Docker Compose**.
- Worked in Agile sprints using **Jira** for task tracking and **Bitbucket** for version control.

Keywords: Java, Spring Boot, gRPC, Kafka, Redis, PostgreSQL, WebSocket, Docker, React.js, Ant Design

Serverless Auction Platform (2025 | Individual)

Architecture | Github 

A capstone project built using AWS, following a microservices architecture with an event-driven, serverless (FaaS) design.

- Architected an event-driven microservices system (Auctions, Auth, Notifications) using **AWS Lambda**, **API Gateway**, and **EventBridge** for scheduled tasks.
- Implemented asynchronous service communication using **SQS** and **SNS** to decouple components and handle email notifications via **SES**.
- Designed a high-performance data model in **DynamoDB** utilizing **Global Secondary Indexes (GSI)** for efficient scheduled querying and **On-Demand Capacity** for auto-scaling.
- Secured API endpoints with a custom **Lambda Authorizer** that validates **JSON Web Tokens (JWT)**, ensuring robust role-based access control.
- Enhanced code reliability and maintainability by integrating **Middy** middleware for input validation and error handling.
- Utilized **LocalStack** and **Docker** to create a comprehensive local development environment that emulates AWS cloud infrastructure.

Keywords: Node.js, Serverless Framework, AWS Lambda, DynamoDB, SQS, SNS, SES, JWT, Middy, LocalStack, Docker

Automated AI Shorts Video Creator (2025 | Individual)

An open-source project to automate the creation of short-form videos using a powerful combination of AI tools and workflow automation.

- Orchestrated a video creation pipeline using **n8n** as the central workflow engine.
- Integrated various AI services for script generation, text-to-speech, and content preparation, including **Together AI**, **OpenRouter**, and **ElevenLabs**.
- Containerized the entire stack using **Docker Compose** for one-click local deployment.
- Implemented notifications via **Telegram** to monitor the automation workflow.

Keywords: n8n, Docker, AI, Workflow Automation, Video Generation

AI Blog Post Generator (2025 | Individual)



A multi-agent system that uses specialized AI agents to generate professional, well-structured, and well-researched blog posts.

- Built with the **Agno Framework** for its beginner-friendly approach to multi-agent workflows.
- Orchestrated research, content extraction, and writing using specialized agents for each task.
- Designed for provider flexibility, with easy switching between **OpenAI**, **Gemini**, **Claude**, and **Groq** models.
- Implemented a user-friendly interface with **Streamlit**, including real-time streaming output.

Keywords: Streamlit, Agno Framework, Pydantic

Maison Vella – E-Commerce Admin Panel (2024 | Individual) Architecture | Live | Github

Comprehensive admin interface for the Maison Vella e-commerce ecosystem, facilitating centralized management of products, orders, and content assets.

- Engineered a responsive **Next.js 14** application using the **App Router**, **ShadCN UI**, and **Tailwind CSS**, ensuring a consistent and accessible design system.
- Implemented a robust backend architecture utilizing **Server Actions** for form handling and **tRPC** with **TanStack Query** for type-safe client-server communication.
- Orchestrated content management by integrating **Sanity** as a **Headless CMS**, consuming data via **GraphQL** for flexible and efficient retrieval.
- Managed transactional data using **Prisma ORM** with **Supabase (PostgreSQL)** in a **Serverless** environment.
- Architected the system using **CQRS**, the **Repository Pattern**, and a **Layered Architecture** within a feature-sliced structure to ensure scalability and maintainability.

- Secured administrative access and role-based operations using **Clerk Auth**.
- Optimized asset delivery and storage by implementing **Cloudflare R2** (S3-compatible) and a global **CDN** for high-performance media handling.

Keywords: Next.js 14 (App Router), Server Actions, TypeScript, tRPC, GraphQL, Prisma, Supabase, Sanity (Headless CMS), Serverless, Cloudflare R2 (CDN), CQRS

Go gRPC GraphQL – Multi-Tenant Microservices (2025 | Individual)

Architected a **polyglot, multi-tenant microservices** platform with a focus on scalability, fault isolation, and unified data access.

- Developed backend services in **Go** using **gRPC** and **Protobuf** for efficient inter-service communication.
- Implemented a **GraphQL API Gateway** to provide a single, unified endpoint for client applications.
- Designed multi-tenant data storage with **PostgreSQL**, **Elasticsearch**, and optional **Cassandra** for high-volume workloads.
- Containerized and orchestrated services using **Docker Compose** for local and staging environments.

Keywords: Go, gRPC, GraphQL, Protobuf, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch, Cassandra, Docker Compose

Fintech & Crypto Trading Automation Lab (Ongoing | Group)

Industry-Mentored Initiative (Ongoing)

Selected to participate in an exclusive, industry-mentored initiative focused on cutting-edge development in fintech, virtual assets, and derivative markets.

- Selected based on strong development skills to work on intelligent automation and production-level projects with real-world deadlines.
- Developing high-performance trading automation tools and fintech solutions with opportunities for mutual ownership.
- Gaining deep exposure to technical analysis (TA), algorithmic trading, and asset management strategies across crypto and forex markets.
- Receiving direct industrial mentorship aimed at long-term growth in personal finance, wealth management, and professional software engineering practices.

Keywords: Fintech, Crypto Trading, Forex, Algorithmic Trading, Technical Analysis, Intelligent Automation, Industrial Mentorship, Personal Finance & Wealth Management

Improving Blockchain Scalability: Throughput Enhancement in ZK-Rollups

Research Project — BSc (Hons) in Computer Science & Engineering, University of Moratuwa

- Designed and implemented a modular ZK-rollup benchmarking framework to evaluate Ethereum Layer-2 performance trade-offs across sequencing, batching, proving, data availability, and Layer-1 settlement.
- Built an end-to-end benchmark pipeline consisting of a Workload Generator, Sequencer, Executor, Prover, Rust-based Submitter, Solidity L1 contracts, and Python data-analysis tools.
- Implemented and refactored the Rust Submitter service to receive finalized L2 batches, select the configured Data Availability mode, submit commitments to the L1 bridge contract, validate transaction receipts, and export settlement metrics.
- Added configurable Data Availability paths including calldata, EIP-4844-style blob mode, and off-chain / Validium-style benchmark mode, enabling controlled comparison of cost, latency, and DA-footprint trade-offs.
- Introduced a mock-testable **BridgeClient** abstraction for L1 interactions, improving Submitter testability and increasing verifiable Submitter test coverage from approximately 41% to 88%.
- Fixed a critical settlement reliability issue by validating L1 transaction receipt status, preventing mined but reverted transactions from being incorrectly recorded as successful benchmark results.
- Contributed Solidity bridge, Data Availability, and verifier-related contracts to provide a local L1 settlement boundary for end-to-end benchmark execution.
- Developed Docker-based benchmark orchestration scripts for service startup, repeated experiment execution, workload triggering, result management, and metrics extraction.
- Built a synthetic Poisson-style workload generator supporting controlled traffic profiles, including an 8 TPS base workload with 80 TPS burst injection for stress testing batching and scheduling behaviour.
- Developed Python data tools to aggregate JSON/JSONL/CSV metrics and compute throughput, P50/P95/P99 latency, finalization time, gas/cost summaries, and DA footprint.
- Generated reproducible benchmark outputs including latency CDFs, cost heatmaps, and Pareto-style trade-off comparisons for the final research evaluation.
- Demonstrated that EIP-4844-style blob data availability reduced data publication cost by approximately 70% compared with calldata in the benchmark environment.

Key Results: Delivered a working end-to-end ZK-rollup benchmark workflow from workload generation to L1 submission and post-experiment analysis; improved Submitter test coverage from approximately 41% to 88%; evaluated 8 TPS base and 80 TPS burst workloads; observed approximately 70% DA publication cost reduction using blob-style DA compared with calldata.

Technologies: Rust, Solidity, Hardhat, TypeScript, Python, Docker, gRPC, SQLite/PostgreSQL, Ethereum Local Test Networks, RISC0 / Mock Proving Path, JSON/JSONL/CSV Metrics, Matplotlib

Blockchain Supply Chain Management DApp (2025 | Individual)

Architecture | Live 

| Github 

Built a full-stack decentralized application (DApp) enabling end-to-end shipment tracking and secure escrow payments on the Ethereum blockchain (Polygon Amoy Testnet).

- Developed a production-grade Solidity smart contract (**Tracking.sol**) using **structs**, **mappings**, and a strict 3-state **enum** lifecycle (**PENDING** → **IN_TRANSIT** → **DELIVERED**), complete with guarded state transitions, timestamped event logs, and full on-chain auditability.
- Implemented a trustless escrow mechanism using **payable** functions—validating **msg.value**, locking funds on creation, and releasing payments only upon verified delivery via **completeShipment**.
- Built a responsive Next.js/React frontend powered by a global **TrackingContext**, providing real-time state management, shipment inspection, and lifecycle actions (create, start, complete).
- Integrated **Ethers.js** and **Web3Modal** for secure wallet connection, dynamic provider/signer selection, MetaMask interaction, and seamless network handling (Localhost → Polygon Amoy).
- Added data-formatting utilities for user-friendly display, including UNIX→date conversion and Ether/Wei transformations using **ethers.utils.formatEther**.
- Implemented polished UI/UX behaviors—loading indicators, masked modals (**maskClosable=false**), and utility helpers (**shortenAddress**, **copyToClipboard**) for high-quality user interaction.
- Designed a manual CI/CD pipeline using GitHub Actions to automate contract deployment (with pre-flight balance checks) and frontend deployment to Vercel, fully parameterized via GitHub Secrets and environment isolation.
- Utilized Hardhat for development, including local blockchain simulation (**npx hardhat node**), compilation, contract verification, and controlled deployment workflows.

Keywords: Solidity, Hardhat, Ethers.js, Web3Modal, Next.js, React Context API, Tailwind CSS, Polygon Amoy, Smart Contracts, Escrow Payments, CI/CD

Governance DAO – Token-Weighted Voting DApp (2025 | Individual)



A decentralized autonomous organization (DAO) voting application on Ethereum.

- Developed **Solidity** smart contracts for proposal creation and token-weighted voting.
- Implemented an ERC-20 governance token for voting power.
- Built a frontend using **React** and **Web3.js** to interact with the blockchain.
- Deployed contracts to the **Sepolia** testnet using **Hardhat**.
- Ensured security through comprehensive unit tests and access control modifiers.

Keywords: Solidity, Ethereum, React, Web3.js, DAO, Smart Contracts, Hardhat

Content-Aware Meme Generator (2025 | Individual)



An AI-powered tool that generates memes based on image context.

- Utilized **OpenAI GPT-4 Vision** to analyze images and generate humorous captions.
- Integrated **Pillow (PIL)** for image processing and text overlay.
- Created a simple web interface using **Streamlit** for user uploads.
- Implemented error handling and rate limiting for API requests.

Keywords: Python, OpenAI Vision API, Pillow, Streamlit, AI, Image Processing

PaperMind – AI Research Assistant (2025 | Individual)



Developed a lightweight, **RAG-powered** platform for intelligent querying of academic papers.

- Enabled PDF uploads for local semantic search and integrated with **arXiv** for external paper retrieval.
- Designed a **LangChain** pipeline with **ChromaDB** vector storage for fast, context-aware lookups.
- Generated embeddings using **Sentence Transformers** for improved retrieval accuracy.
- Delivered LLM-generated responses using **Gemini API** and HuggingFace models.

Keywords: Streamlit, LangChain, ChromaDB, Sentence Transformers, Gemini API, HuggingFace

RPAL Interpreter – Functional Language Compiler (2024 | Group)



Engineered a complete compiler and interpreter for the RPAL (Right-reference Pedagogic Algorithmic Language), built from scratch to parse and evaluate programs according to official language grammar and semantics.

- Developed a Lexical Analyzer using custom Finite State Automata (FSA) and regex-based token identification.
- Built an Abstract Syntax Tree (AST) and Standard Tree (ST) generator.
- Implemented a CSE Machine to evaluate programs using 13 semantic rules of RPAL.
- Built a robust testing framework with **Pytest** covering over 168 test cases across AST, ST, and full output validation.
- Automated build and test pipelines using **Makefiles** and **GitHub Actions**.
- Supports interactive CLI switches (-ast, -st, -ct, -t, -ft) for granular output inspection.

Keywords: Python, Pytest, GitHub Actions, Makefile, CLI

Virtual Me – 3D Animated AI Chatbot (2024 | Individual)



Created an interactive 3D virtual assistant with lifelike animations and AI-driven conversations.

- Integrated **Hugging Face** (Mixtral model) for natural language dialogue.
- Implemented **Eleven Labs** TTS for human-like voice output.
- Synchronized lip movements and facial expressions using **Rhubarb**.
- Built immersive 3D interface with **React** and **Three.js**.
- Developed backend using **Node.js** and **Express.js** for API orchestration and audio processing.

Keywords: React (Three.js), Node.js, Express.js, Hugging Face, Eleven Labs, Rhubarb, FFmpeg

Professional Training, Coursework & Certificates

See all certificates

- | | |
|---|---|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) Training
<i>CodeKloud</i> (Mumshad Mannambeth) — Completed 27h curriculum with 50+ hands-on labs. | <i>Apr 2025</i>
View certificate |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • AWS Certified Solutions Architect Associate (SAA-C03) Training
<i>Udemy</i> (Stephane Maarek) — Completed 27.5h comprehensive cloud architecture course. | <i>Aug 2025</i>
View certificate |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Apache Kafka Series (v3) – Learn Kafka for Beginners
<i>Udemy</i> (Stephane Maarek) — Full System Design & Setup. | <i>Mar 2025</i>
[Part 1] [Part 2] [Part 3] |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • 100 Days of DevOps (Bootcamp)
<i>CodeKloud</i> — Intensive hands-on training covering Linux, Python, Docker, Jenkins, Terraform & Ansible. | <i>Nov 2025</i>
View certificate |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Implementing Software Architecture for Large-Scale Systems
<i>Udemy</i> | <i>Apr 2025</i>
View certificate |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Advanced OAuth Security
<i>Udemy</i> | <i>Mar 2024</i>
View certificate |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Next.js: Build Scalable React Apps with Page & App Routers
<i>Udemy</i> — Instructors: Anton Voroniuk, Denys Kohut, Anton Voroniuk Support | <i>Nov 2025</i>
View certificate |

Skills

Core	Java Spring Boot Microservices Distributed Systems System Design REST APIs
Backend	Spring Cloud Spring Security Resilience4j Node.js Express.js Gin
Messaging & APIs	Kafka RabbitMQ gRPC GraphQL WebSockets Protobuf JWT OAuth 2.0
Data	PostgreSQL MySQL Oracle DB Redis Couchbase
Cloud & DevOps	AWS Docker Kubernetes CI/CD (GitHub Actions, Jenkins)
Testing	JMeter Gatling Pytest Unit Testing
Tools	Git Gradle Postman Jira Confluence

References available upon request.